

D697

Literacy Assessment and Interventions

Armored Drill

8 concepts · 12 items · 4 transfer items

What this is. Every concept in this course's public description, re-asked with more disguise than a practice test uses. Each stem carries facts that do not decide it. Every wrong answer is a named trap.

Source. Scope from the course's public description in the WGU Institutional Catalog (September 2026); items written from the field's standard body of knowledge. No WGU assessment item, course material or proprietary content is used or reproduced. Not affiliated with or endorsed by Western Governors University.

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How to run it

Paper first. Pencil. One pass, no notes, a timer if you want the pressure.

1. **Before you read the options**, fill the strip under the item: the target word (what is actually being asked), and the one fact in the stem that decides it.
2. **Principle before arithmetic**. Name the rule, then compute.
3. **Camouflage**. Most of every stem does not matter. Ask: which single fact decides this?
4. **Inverse pairs are the bait**. If two options are opposites, one of them is the trap built for you.
5. **Mark sure, unsure or guess** honestly. Sure-and-wrong is the most valuable miss on the page — it is a wrong mental model.
6. **Absolutes** (always, never, guarantee) are usually wrong. And recognizing an answer is not the same as owning it.
7. Items with a **heavy black bar** on the left are **transfer items**: the same principle, reversed or solved for a different variable.
8. Stop at the STOP page. Then grade, fill the triage grid, and tally the traps you fell for. The biggest tally is what you drill next.

The strip, filled in, looks like this:

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	_____	

Items

1.

A school gives every K–3 student a three-minute reading measure each fall, winter, and spring. The measure is administered by a trained team in the library, and results are uploaded to the district’s new dashboard. What is the main purpose of this measure?

- A. An outcome measure for state accountability.
- B. Progress monitoring for students in intervention.
- C. Diagnostic assessment to pinpoint each student’s specific skill gaps.
- D. Universal screening to identify students who may be at risk.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

2. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A teacher already knows a second grader is at risk in reading and now needs to know exactly which phonics patterns the student has not mastered. Which assessment type fits?

- A. A universal screener.
- B. A state end-of-year test.
- C. A diagnostic phonics inventory.
- D. A weekly fluency probe, which always shows exact phonics gaps.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

3.

A third grader with a strong attendance record qualifies for Tier 2 reading support. The interventionist, who has a master’s degree, is free only during the class’s 90-minute core reading block. What is the best scheduling decision?

- A. Schedule Tier 2 at a different time so the student still gets core reading.
- B. Let the interventionist decide based on credentials.
- C. Move the student straight to Tier 3.
- D. Pull the student during core reading, since Tier 2 replaces Tier 1.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

4.

A kindergarten teacher, during a rainy-day indoor recess, asks students: "Say 'mat.' Now change /m/ to /s/. What word do you have?" No letters or cards are used. Some students are wearing costumes for a class play. What skill is this?

- A. Fluency.
- B. Phonemic awareness (phoneme substitution).
- C. Phonics.
- D. Syllable awareness, since any sound task is at the syllable level.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

5. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A teacher wants to turn a phonemic awareness activity into a phonics activity. What change does that?

- A. Remove the sounds and show pictures only.
- B. Have students do the same task with eyes closed.
- C. Have students clap syllables instead.
- D. Have students build and change the words with letter tiles.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

6.

A second grader reads a 250-word grade-level passage for one minute during a quiet morning in the reading nook. When the timer ends, she is on word 112 and has made 8 errors. She self-corrected 3 other words. What is her WCPM?

- A. 112
- B. 104
- C. 120
- D. 101

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

7.

A fourth grader reads a 200-word passage from the class's new science series and makes 16 errors. He says he enjoys the topic. At what level is this text for him?

- A. Independent, because he enjoys the topic.
- B. Instructional (92%).
- C. Frustration (84%).
- D. Independent (92%).

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

8. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A teacher wants a 150-word passage to be at a student's independent level (at least 95% accuracy). What is the greatest number of errors the student can make?

- A. 15
- B. 8
- C. 7
- D. 5

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

9.

A bright second grader with strong math skills and a big vocabulary struggles to decode new words and spell even after solid classroom instruction. His parents, both engineers, ask whether colored overlays or eye exercises will help. What is the best response?

- A. Recommend colored overlays, since dyslexia is a visual problem.
- B. Focus on math, his strength, until reading catches up.
- C. Reassure them he will outgrow it because he is bright.
- D. Explain that his profile suggests a phonological-based difficulty and recommend evaluation and explicit, systematic structured literacy instruction.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

10.

A student's baseline is 40 WCPM and the goal is 64 WCPM in 12 weeks. After six weeks of a Tier 2 fluency group that meets in the school's new literacy lab, the last four weekly scores are all below the aim line, though each is a little higher than the week before. What should the team do?

- A.** Change or intensify the intervention.
- B.** Keep the intervention, since scores are rising.
- C.** Lower the goal to match the current trend.
- D.** Exit the student, since four points is always enough to decide.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

11. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A student's baseline is 40 WCPM and the goal is 64 WCPM in 12 weeks. What weekly growth does the aim line require?

- A.** 5.3 WCPM per week
- B.** 3.3 WCPM per week
- C.** 2 WCPM per week
- D.** 24 WCPM per week

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

12.

A third grader reads 45 WCPM with 85% accuracy on grade-level text. She has a warm relationship with her teacher and attends an after-school club. Her teacher plans daily repeated readings to build speed. What is the best adjustment?

- A.** Assess and target decoding first, since low accuracy is driving the slow rate.
- B.** Keep repeated reading, since the problem is fluency.
- C.** Add a timer to push her speed higher.
- D.** Focus on comprehension strategies.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

STOP

Answers and dissection follow. Finish every item and every strip first.

Key and dissection

Struck-through text is the camouflage: facts that do not decide the item.

1. Answer D Concept 1

A school gives every K-3 student a three-minute reading measure each fall, winter, and spring. The measure is ~~administered by a trained team in the library~~, and results are ~~uploaded to the district's new dashboard~~. What is the main purpose of this measure?

Target word: purpose of a brief measure given to all **Decides:** Brief, given to everyone, three times a year: universal screening.

A	Camouflage	The district dashboard does not make it an accountability test.
B	Adjacent category	Monitoring is frequent (weekly or biweekly) for students receiving intervention.
C	Confusion set	Diagnostics are longer and given to flagged students to find the exact gap.
D	Correct	Short measures given to all students at set points are screeners.

2. Answer C Concept 1 • transfer

A teacher already knows a second grader is at risk in reading and now needs to know exactly which phonics patterns the student has not mastered. Which assessment type fits?

Target word: pick the type from the need **Decides:** Pinpointing specific gaps is diagnostic.

A	Inverted operation	Screening answers who is at risk, which is already known.
B	Adjacent category	Outcome tests are too broad to guide specific instruction.
C	Correct	Diagnostics identify specific skills to teach.
D	Absolute language	Fluency probes show progress, not which patterns are missing.

3. Answer A Concept 2

A third grader ~~with a strong attendance record~~ qualifies for Tier 2 reading support. The interventionist, ~~who has a master's degree~~, is free only during the class's 90-minute core reading block. What is the best scheduling decision?

Target word: schedule decision **Decides:** Tier 2 is in addition to Tier 1 core instruction.

A	Correct	Tiered support supplements core instruction; it does not replace it.
B	Camouflage	The degree does not answer the scheduling question.
C	Adjacent category	Tier 3 is for students who need more intensity, not a scheduling fix.
D	Inverted operation	Replaces rather than adds, reducing total instruction.

4. Answer B Concept 3

A kindergarten teacher, ~~during a rainy day indoor recess~~, asks students: "Say 'mat.' Now change /m/ to /s/. What word do you have?" No letters or cards are used. ~~Some students are wearing costumes for a class play.~~ What skill is this?

Target word: name the skill **Decides:** Oral sound manipulation with no print.

A	Adjacent category	Fluency is accurate, expressive reading of connected text.
B	Correct	Manipulating individual sounds orally is phonemic awareness.
C	Confusion set	Phonics requires linking sounds to letters; no letters are used.
D	Absolute language	The task changes a single phoneme, not a syllable.

5. Answer D Concept 3 • transfer

A teacher wants to turn a phonemic awareness activity into a phonics activity. What change does that?

Target word: what converts PA to phonics **Decides:** Adding letters (print).

A	Inverted operation	Moves away from sound-letter linking.
B	Dropped element	Still no print; nothing links sound to letter.
C	Adjacent category	Still oral: phonological awareness.
D	Correct	Mapping sounds to letters makes it phonics.

6. Answer B Concept 4

A second grader reads a ~~250-word~~ grade-level passage for one minute ~~during a quiet morning in the reading nook~~. When the timer ends, she is on word 112 and has made 8 errors. ~~She self-corrected 3 other words~~. What is her WCPM?

Target word: WCPM **Decides:** 112 attempted – 8 errors in one minute.

A	Dropped element	Forgets to subtract errors.
B	Correct	$(112 - 8) \div 1 = 104$; self-corrections are not errors.
C	Inverted operation	Adds errors instead of subtracting.
D	Camouflage	Counts self-corrections as errors; they are not.

7. Answer B Concept 5

A fourth grader reads a 200-word passage ~~from the class's new science series~~ and makes 16 errors. ~~He says he enjoys the topic~~. At what level is this text for him?

Target word: accuracy level **Decides:** $184 \div 200 = 92\%$.

A	Camouflage	Interest does not change accuracy.
B	Correct	92% falls in the 90–94% instructional band.
C	Wrong stem number	Subtracts 16 from 100 as if errors were a percent.
D	Adjacent category	Right percent, wrong band; independent is about 95% or higher.

8. Answer C Concept 5 • transfer

A teacher wants a 150-word passage to be at a student's independent level (at least 95% accuracy). What is the greatest number of errors the student can make?

Target word: solve for errors **Decides:** $150 \times 0.05 = 7.5$, so at most 7 errors.

A	Adjacent category	That is the 90% (instructional) floor.
B	Inverted operation	Rounds 7.5 up, which drops accuracy below 95%.
C	Correct	$143 \div 150 = 95.3\%$; 8 errors gives 94.7%, below 95%.
D	Wrong stem number	Uses the 5 from 95% as a raw error count.

9. Answer D Concept 6

A bright second grader ~~with strong math skills~~ and a big vocabulary struggles to decode new words and spell even after solid classroom instruction. His parents, ~~both engineers~~, ask whether colored overlays or eye exercises will help. What is the best response?

Target word: best response **Decides:** Profile fits phonological-based dyslexia; evidence supports structured literacy.

A	Confusion set	Dyslexia is not primarily visual; overlays lack evidence.
B	Camouflage	His math strength does not address the reading need.
C	Absolute language	Dyslexia is not outgrown; strong ability makes the difficulty unexpected, not temporary.
D	Correct	Dyslexia is language-based; structured literacy is the evidence-based approach.

10. Answer A Concept 7

A student's baseline is 40 WCPM and the goal is 64 WCPM in 12 weeks. After six weeks of a Tier 2 fluency group ~~that meets in the school's new literacy lab~~, the last four weekly scores are all below the aim line, though each is a little higher than the week before. What should the team do?

Target word: decision from the data **Decides:** Four consecutive points below the aim line.

A	Correct	Consecutive points below the aim line signal that growth is too slow to reach the goal.
B	Dropped element	Drops the aim line; rising slowly is not enough.
C	Inverted operation	Moves the target to the data instead of changing instruction.
D	Absolute language	Exiting is for points above the goal; the rule points to changing instruction.

11. Answer C Concept 7 • transfer

A student's baseline is 40 WCPM and the goal is 64 WCPM in 12 weeks. What weekly growth does the aim line require?

Target word: solve for weekly growth **Decides:** $(64 - 40) \div 12$.

A	Dropped element	$64 \div 12$ ignores the baseline.
B	Inverted operation	$40 \div 12$ uses the baseline instead of the gain.
C	Correct	$24 \div 12 = 2$.
D	Wrong stem number	Total growth, not weekly.

12. Answer A Concept 8

A third grader reads 45 WCPM with 85% accuracy on grade-level text. ~~She has a warm relationship with her teacher and attends an after-school club.~~ Her teacher plans daily repeated readings to build speed. What is the best adjustment?

Target word: which skill to target first **Decides:** 85% accuracy shows a decoding problem under the slow rate.

A	Correct	Fix the most foundational weak skill; speed practice on inaccurate reading rehearses errors.
B	Confusion set	Names the symptom, not the cause.
C	Inverted operation	Pushes speed when accuracy is the problem.
D	Adjacent category	Comprehension is above the broken skill; decoding must come first.

Triage grid

Write each item number in the box it belongs to.

	Right	Wrong
Sure	Owned.	Concept inversion — top priority. A wrong mental model; it survives rewording.
Unsure / guess	Recognition, not mastery. Re-drill with the transfer.	Not learned yet.

Trap tally

For every miss, find the letter you chose in the key and tally its trap. The biggest number is the pattern to drill.

Trap	What it does	In this drill	Your misses
Dropped element	Leaves out a required term or step.	4	
Wrong stem number	A figure copied from the prompt that is not the answer.	3	
Adjacent category	The right idea in the wrong bucket.	8	
Inverted operation	Direction flipped: add/subtract, cause/effect, higher/lower.	8	
Absolute language	Always, never, guarantee — where judgment applies.	4	
Confusion set	Every option is real; the test is exact role-matching.	4	
Camouflage	Answers a stem fact that was never the question.	5	

Anchor rows — the concept list

One row per concept: the rule to lock in, the trap that catches people, and the tell in the question that signals it.

#	Concept	Rule	Trap	Tell
1	Four purposes of assessment	Screening flags who may be at risk; diagnostic pinpoints the specific skill gap; progress monitoring checks whether an intervention is working; outcome measures judge end-of-period achievement.	Using a quick screener to plan exactly what to teach.	“Who is at risk?” vs. “What exactly is missing?” vs. “Is it working?”
2	MTSS tiers add, not replace	Tier 1 is core instruction for all; Tier 2 adds targeted small-group support; Tier 3 adds intensive, individualized support; higher tiers are in addition to Tier 1.	Pulling Tier 2/3 students out of core reading instruction.	When or instead of what the intervention is scheduled.
3	Phonemic awareness vs. phonics	Phonemic awareness is hearing and manipulating individual sounds in spoken words (no print); phonics links sounds to letters.	Calling a letter-sound task phonemic awareness.	Whether letters or print are involved.
4	Words correct per minute	WCPM = (words attempted – errors) ÷ minutes read.	Reporting total words read, or adding errors.	A one-minute read with a word count and an error count.
5	Accuracy levels	Accuracy = words correct ÷ total words; about 95%+ is independent, 90–94% instructional, below 90% frustration.	Treating the error count as the percent, or choosing a frustration-level text for practice.	Errors out of a passage length.
6	Dyslexia and structured literacy	Dyslexia is a language-based difficulty rooted mainly in phonological processing, shown in weak decoding and spelling despite adequate instruction; it is addressed with explicit, systematic, cumulative structured literacy.	Thinking dyslexia is seeing letters backward and is treated with colored lenses or vision training.	Unexpected decoding and spelling difficulty in a capable student.
7	Progress-monitoring decision rules	Set an aim line from baseline to goal; if several consecutive points (often 3–4) fall below it, change the intervention.	Staying the course because the student is “improving a little.”	A graph of weekly scores against a goal line.
8	Intervene at the lowest broken skill	Fix the most foundational skill that is weak first: low fluency caused by inaccurate decoding needs decoding work, not just repeated reading for speed.	Targeting the skill named in the symptom (fluency) instead of its cause (decoding).	Slow reading plus low accuracy.

Course scope (public description): Literacy Assessment and Interventions is an essential course for candidates to enhance their skills in identifying and addressing literacy challenges in all student populations, including students with dyslexia, through Tier 1, Tier 2, and Tier 3 multi-tiered systems of support and assessment (MTSS). This course reviews the science of reading associated with a wide range of assessments and techniques used to evaluate reading, writing, speaking, and listening skills. Students learn to administer and interpret assessments, using the data to identify specific literacy needs and learning gaps. A significant focus of the course is on designing

and implementing targeted intervention strategies to support student learning in areas, such as phonemic awareness, phonics, fluency, comprehension, and vocabulary development. By exploring and implementing actionable steps to monitor student progress, candidates gain expertise in improving literacy outcomes for all learners.